

THE MOVE

Concern named + why it makes sense + clarifying bridge + response. -> That is a fair concern. If this felt rushed, I would be cautious too. Is the main worry timing or risk? -> I can see why cost would be the sticking point. The question is whether ?

START HERE

Say "That is a fair concern" and name the concern out loud before you respond.

SAY THIS

Quick validators	<i>"That is a fair concern."</i>
Natural and warm	<i>"Given what happened last time, I would be cautious too."</i>
Professional	<i>"That is a legitimate risk to consider."</i>
Persuasive / bridge t...	<i>"That concern is exactly why I would suggest a smaller first step."</i>
Conflict-safe	<i>"I am not dismissing that."</i>
High-status / busy pe...	<i>"That is the right risk to test."</i>

AVOID

- The person needs safety, privacy, silence or direct practical help instead
- They want a straight answer or information, not more acknowledgement
- The issue is a firm boundary, not a negotiable concern

REMEMBER

Validate the worry before you answer the worry — never validate false facts as true.